Scott Clark, Ph.D.

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Co-founder & CEO at Distributional, Inc.
Palo Alto, CA
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Note: This is a longform academic CV, for a shortform resume (< 2 pages) see ScottClarkResume.pdf

Summary. Three-time founder/executive building ML/AI infrastructure across research, open-source, enterprise, and startup settings. Currently co-founder & CEO of Distributional, building Talaria Scientific, a multi-agent harness for computational science research. Previously VP & GM at Intel (Nov 2020 – Jun 2023, 200-person AI/HPC Supercomputing org) following Intel's acquisition of SigOpt, where I was co-founder & CEO (2014–2020). Cornell Ph.D. in Applied Mathematics under Prof. Peter Frazier. 15 peer-reviewed papers and ∼20 granted US patents (1,200+ citations, h-index 16), 40+ conference talks and podcast appearances.

Education

- **Cornell University** — Ithaca, NY
  Ph.D. Applied Mathematics; M.S. Computer Science — *2008 – 2012*
  - *Department of Energy Computational Science Graduate Fellow* (full 4-year scholarship; DOE contract DE-FG02-97ER25308; ∼20 awarded nationally per year).
  - Dissertation: "**Parallel Machine Learning Algorithms in Bioinformatics and Global Optimization**," defended Aug 2012.
  - Advisor: Prof. Peter Frazier (ORIE). Committee: Prof. Steve Strogatz, Prof. Bart Selman. Research collaborator (not committee): Dr. Zhong Wang (JGI practicum supervisor + ALE co-author).
  - NERSC Startup + Production Allocation as PI (Cray XT4, DOE contract DE-AC02-05CH11231).
- **Oregon State University** — Corvallis, OR
  B.Sc. Mathematics, B.Sc. Computational Physics, B.Sc. Physics — *2004 – 2008*
  - Graduated *magna cum laude* with three separate Bachelor of Science degrees in four years.
  - Minors in Actuarial Sciences and Mathematical Sciences. Paradigms in Physics track.
  - Undergraduate thesis: "Finite Element Modeling on Uncertain Surfaces," advisor Prof. Malgorzata Peszynska (Mathematics); URISC + NSF Grant 0511190. Computational-physics program led by Prof. Rubin Landau.

Executive & Industry Experience

- **Distributional, Inc.** — `distributional.com` — Palo Alto, CA
  Co-founder & CEO — *July 2023 – present*
  - Pivoted to Talaria Scientific in July 2026 (same corporation, same investors, new mission): a multi-agent harness for computational science research — scientist-in-the-loop agents with HPC as the guardrail, in private beta. The announcement.
  - Analytics for AI agents — discovering behavioral signals in agent trace data for continuous AI reliability. 30-person team, $30M raised (Seed Dec 2023 led by Andreessen Horowitz; Series A Oct 2024 led by Two Sigma Ventures).

- Co-founders: Michael McCourt (CTO; multi-paper SigOpt-era co-author), David Rosales (COO), Nick Payton (CRO). 11-person founding team sourced from Bloomberg, Google, Meta, Intel, SigOpt, Slack, Stripe, Uber, Yelp.
- Product evolved 2023–2025 from pre-deployment AI-testing to production behavioral analytics for AI agents; sunset with the July 2026 pivot to Talaria.
- US Patent 12,505,027 (2025, named inventor): anomaly detection in deployed AI applications.

- **Intel Corporation** Portland, OR
  VP & GM, AI & HPC Supercomputing Application Level Engineering *November 2020 – June 2023*
  - Joined Intel through the $*undisclosed* acquisition of SigOpt (Oct 2020). Led a multi-disciplinary ∼200-person organization responsible for application-level AI and HPC software within Intel's Supercomputing Group.
  - **Title progression:** *Director & GM of SigOpt* (Nov 2020 – Mar 2021) → *Senior Director & GM of SigOpt and AI Application Enablement* (Mar 2021 – Sep 2022) → *VP & GM of AI and HPC Supercomputing Application Level Engineering* (Sep 2022 – Jun 2023).
  - Public face for Intel's oneAPI open-ecosystem thesis — SC22 theCUBE panel (Dallas, Nov 2022), MLconf 2021 Webinar, Ai4 2021, Intel Conversations in the Cloud Ep. 250.
  - Integrated SigOpt's IP into Intel's AI Analytics Toolkit; recognized as a leader in AI Software Optimization (Kisaco Research Leadership Council, 2021).
- **SigOpt Inc.** — `sigopt.com` San Francisco, CA
  Co-founder & CEO *November 2014 – November 2020*
  - Commercial Bayesian-optimization platform serving Fortune 500 enterprises in finance, trading, intelligence, and technology. Acquired by Intel (Oct 29, 2020).
  - Raised $17M across seed + Series A + Series A+ + strategic rounds: Andreessen Horowitz (led seed 2015 and A 2016); Blumberg Capital (lead, 2018 Series A+, with Two Sigma Investments co-investing, announced 2019); Data Collective (DCVC), SV Angel, Stanford, In-Q-Tel strategic, Y Combinator (W15), and notable angels.
  - Co-founders: Patrick Hayes (CTO 2014–2021), Eric Liu.
  - Grew from Y Combinator W15 through Series A+ with customers in algorithmic trading, government/intelligence, enterprise AI, and consumer-tech.
  - Awards: Gartner Cool Vendor in AI Core Technologies (2017); Barclays Open Innovation Challenge winner (2017); Kisaco Research KLC Leader (2021).
  - Drove research culture and IP: 15 peer-reviewed papers + ∼20 granted US patents as named inventor across Intelligent Optimization Platform, Multi-Criteria Optimization, and Multi-Solution Hyperparameter Tuning families.
- **Yelp Inc.** San Francisco, CA
  Data Mining Engineer and Lead on Ad Targeting Team *July 2012 – December 2014*
  - **Optimization:** Co-developed and led team for **MOE** (Metric Optimization Engine, `github.com/Yelp/MOE`) — first production Bayesian-optimization open-source package. Third-most-popular Yelp open-source release within 72 hours of launch; basis of SigOpt's founding.
  - **Ad targeting:** Implemented multi-armed bandit strategies for ad selection, sole targeting engineer on mobile ads rollout, developed location-based targeting algorithms.
  - **Director, Yelp Dataset Challenge:** created, implemented, and directed `yelp.com/dataset_challenge`; used by 100,000+ students worldwide since its inception.
  - **Leadership:** Founded Yelp's internal Applied Learning Group (bi-weekly all-engineering speaker series); MOE team lead; intern and new-hire mentor; 200+ technical interviews.

  - Featured in the *Wall Street Journal*, Aug 8 2014 (Elizabeth Dwoskin, "Big Data's High-Priests of Algorithms") and the Cornell ORIE alumni spotlight (2014).

- **Bloomberg LP** — New York, NY
  Financial Software Development Intern — *May – August 2011*
  - Developed end-to-end portfolio-analytics function in C++ and JavaScript (concept → back-end integration → GUI → PDF reporting).

Research Experience (pre-PhD and practicums)

- **DOE Joint Genome Institute (LBNL)** — Walnut Creek, CA
  DOE CSGF Practicum under Dr. Zhong Wang & Rob Egan — *May – Aug 2010*
  - Built open-source genome-assembly validation framework (**ALE**, published *Bioinformatics* 2013, 208 cites).
- **Los Alamos National Laboratory** — Los Alamos, NM
  DOE CSGF Practicum under Drs. Nick Hengartner & Joel Berendzen — *May – Aug 2009*
  - Metagenomics / local sequence-alignment algorithms in Python, C, and CUDA (`Velvetrope`). This practicum pivoted my dissertation from computational fluid dynamics to bioinformatics.
- **Max Planck Institute for the Physics of Complex Systems** — Dresden, Germany
  NSF REU under Prof. Steven Tomsovic (WSU) — *May – Aug 2007*
  - Extreme-value statistics of chaotic quantum systems in MATLAB and FORTRAN.
- **University of California, Davis** — Davis, CA
  NSF REU under Prof. Daniel Cox — *May – Aug 2006*
  - Computational biophysics / protein folding in Java. Results published in *Prion* (2008).

Peer-Reviewed Publications

1. J Wang, SC Clark, E Liu, PI Frazier. "Parallel Bayesian Global Optimization of Expensive Functions." *Operations Research* 68(6):1850–1865, 2020. **263 cites.** (arXiv:1602.05149, DBLP journals/ior/WangCLF20.)
2. I Dewancker, M McCourt, S Clark. "Bayesian Optimization for Machine Learning: A Practical Guidebook." arXiv:1612.04858, 2016. **142 cites.**
3. SC Clark. "Adaptive Sequential Experimentation Techniques for A/B Testing and Model Tuning." *WWW 2015 Companion*, p. 911.
4. I Dewancker, M McCourt, S Clark, P Hayes, A Johnson, G Ke. "A Stratified Analysis of Bayesian Optimization Methods." arXiv:1603.09441, 2016.
5. I Dewancker, M McCourt, S Clark, P Hayes, A Johnson, G Ke. "A Strategy for Ranking Optimization Methods Using Multiple Criteria." Workshop on Automatic Machine Learning (AutoML, ICML), *PMLR* v.64, 2016.
6. I Dewancker, M McCourt, S Clark. "Evaluation System for a Bayesian Optimization Service." arXiv:1605.06170, 2016.

7. SC Clark, R Egan, PI Frazier, Z Wang. "ALE: a generic assembly likelihood evaluation framework for assessing the accuracy of genome and metagenome assemblies." *Bioinformatics* 29(4):435–443, 2013. **208 cites.**
8. P Frazier, SC Clark. "Parallel global optimization using an improved multi-points expected improvement criterion." INFORMS Optimization Society Conference, Miami, 2012.
9. S Clark, E Liu, P Frazier, JL Wang, D Oktay, N Vesdapunt. "MOE: A global, black-box optimization engine for real-world metric optimization." 2014.
10. KC Kunes, SC Clark, DL Cox, RR Singh. "Left-handed β-helix models for mammalian prion fibrils." *Prion* 2(2):81–90, 2008.
11. SC Clark. *Parallel Machine Learning Algorithms in Bioinformatics and Global Optimization.* Ph.D. dissertation, Cornell University, Aug 2012.
12. SC Clark. "Solving Genomic Jigsaws." *DEIXIS Magazine* (DOE CSGF outreach), 2010. (DOE CSGF Communicating Science Award, Honorable Mention.)
13. *See also:* 5 more SigOpt-era papers and preprints on Bayesian optimization / ranking / MOE (full list available on Google Scholar `mwWbhAUAAAAJ`).

Total citations: 1,221 (Google Scholar, as of 2026). h-index: 16. i10-index: 28.

Patents (Selected, as Named Inventor)

∼20 granted US patents across 4 SigOpt patent families (2019–2025) plus 1 Distributional patent (2025). Inventor teams include Patrick Hayes, Michael McCourt, Alexandra Johnson, George Ke, Bolong Cheng, Olivia Kim, Kelvin Tee, Jim Blomo, and others. Selected:

- **Intelligent Optimization Platform** (core SigOpt IP, 11 patents 2019–2025): US 10,217,061; US 10,282,237; US 10,445,150; US 10,607,159; US 11,163,615; US 11,301,781; and others.
- **Multi-Criteria Optimization** (7 patents 2020–2024): US 10,528,891; US 10,558,934; US 10,740,695; US 12,033,036; and others.
- **Multi-Solution Hyperparameter Tuning** (2 patents 2022 & 2024, plus pending): US 11,270,217; and others.
- **Anomaly Detection in Deployed AI Applications** (Distributional, 2025): US 12,505,027. Inventors: Clark, McCourt, Bourassa-Denis, Laban, Kim, Dewancker, Cheng.

Board & Civic Service

- **Oregon Museum of Science and Industry (OMSI), Board of Trustees** — Portland, OR, Aug 2022 – Jul 2025. Treasurer, Executive Committee member, Chair of the Finance Committee.
- **Oregon State University, College of Science, Board of Advisors** — May 2019 – Jun 2025.
- **Oregon State University, College of Science, Industry and Innovation Council** — Nov 2019 – Jun 2025.

Honors, Grants & Recognition

Forbes 30 Under 30, Enterprise Technology . . . 2016
OSU College of Science Young Alumni Award . . . 2016
Department of Energy Computational Science Graduate Fellowship (DOE CSGF, $300,000) 2008–2012
NERSC Production Allocation (PI; 100,000 Cray XT4 hours) . . . 2012
NERSC Startup Allocation + Renewals (PI; Cray XT4) . . . 2010–2012
DOE CSGF Communicating Science Award, Honorable Mention (*DEIXIS* 2010) . . . 2010
Cornell University Sage Fellowship ($55,000, declined) . . . 2008–2009
Joel Davis Award in Mathematics (OSU, $1,000) . . . 2007–2008
URISC Undergraduate Research Fellowship ($1,500) . . . 2007–2008
NSF Research Experience for Undergraduates (MPI PKS Dresden) . . . 2007
NSF Research Experience for Undergraduates (UC Davis) . . . 2006
Paul Copson Memorial Scholarship in Physics (OSU, $1,000) . . . 2006–2007
Nicodemus Scholarship in Physics (OSU, $1,000) . . . 2005–2006

Selected Invited Talks, Keynotes, & Conference Appearances

40+ documented conference and podcast appearances, 2013–2026. Full catalog with video/audio links and transcripts: `github.com/sc932`.

- **Distributional / Intel / recent (2021–2026):** SuperComputing SC22 theCUBE Panel on oneAPI (Dallas, Nov 2022); GenAI Week Silicon Valley 2025; AI + a16z Podcast (2025, with Matt Bornstein); CEO.com (2025); BAM "Coffee with a Founder" (2025); SAIR Podcast w/ Chuck Ng (Mar 2026); Intel CitC Ep. 250 (2021); MLconf Webinar 2021; Ai4 2021.
- **SigOpt (2014–2020):** MLconf SF (2014, 2016); MLconf Seattle (2017); NVIDIA GTC Silicon Valley (2017, 2019); O'Reilly AI NY (2019, co-presented with Matt Greenwood, Two Sigma CIO); Ai4 Finance (2019, panel + solo); TWIMLcon (2019); The AI Conference Startup Showcase (2017); Cornell CAM Notable Alumni Speaker Series (Dec 2019, 76-min career-arc talk); SigOpt Summit 2021 keynote; With The Best online conference; ICML 2017 booth.
- **Yelp / early career (2013–2014):** CMU Silicon Valley TOCS Colloquium (Apr 2013); Yelp Engineering Open House (Nov 2013, "Optimal Learning for Fun and Profit"); Stanford AI Lab; Microsoft Research; UC Berkeley; Cornell CAM; ACM RecSys 2014 (Palo Alto); Hack Lab Zagreb.

Podcast Guest Appearances (Selected)

- **TWIML AI Podcast (Sam Charrington):** Episode 50 (2017), Episode 273 (2019, w/ Matthew Adereth of Two Sigma), Episode 324, TWIMLcon 2019, and 2022 fireside chat. 5+ appearances over 5 years.
- **Voices in AI with Byron Reese:** Episode 12 (Oct 2017, 56-min long-form).
- **Emerj / AI in Business Podcast** (Daniel Faggella, 2017); **IT Visionaries** (2021); **Intel Conversations in the Cloud** Ep. 250 (2021); **CEO.com** (2025); **AI + a16z** w/ Matt Bornstein (2025); **SAIR** w/ Chuck Ng (Mar 2026).

Press Coverage (Selected)

- *Wall Street Journal*, "Big Data's High-Priests of Algorithms / Academic Researchers Find Lucrative Work as 'Big Data' Scientists." By Elizabeth Dwoskin, Aug 8, 2014.
- Cornell ORIE Alumni Spotlight: "Scott Clark Ph.D. '12 brings his work with ORIE Professor Frazier to Yelp and the open source world" (2014).
- OSU College of Science IMPACT: "Meet Scott Clark, an OSU science alum who built a $30M AI startup" (Tom Henderson, Jul 2025); "Young Alumni Award Winner Makes Forbes' 30 Under 30 List" (Nov 2016).
- *DEIXIS Magazine* (DOE CSGF): feature profile (2011, p. 17); author of "Solving Genomic Jigsaws" (2010, DOE CSGF Communicating Science Honorable Mention).
- SiliconANGLE / theCUBE coverage of SC22 (Nov 2022, "VP and GM of AI and HPC Supercomputing Application-Level Engineering").
- Pulse2 (Amit Chowdhry, Mar 2025) — Distributional profile interview.

Selected Bylined Writing (beyond peer-reviewed)

- **SigOpt Blog** (2015–2020): 23 authored posts on Bayesian optimization and enterprise-AI strategy (`sigopt.com/blog`, via Wayback).
- **Yelp Engineering Blog** (2013–2014): 5 authored posts including the canonical MOE launch ("Introducing MOE," 2014-07-24) and 3 Yelp Dataset Challenge announcements.
- **Distributional Blog** (2023–2024): Company fundraise announcements.
- **NVIDIA Parallel Forall** (2017-08-03, w/ S. Tartakovsky and M. McCourt): "Deep Learning Hyperparameter Optimization with Competing Objectives."
- **AWS AI Blog** (2017-05-01, w/ S. Tartakovsky and M. McCourt): "Fast CNN Tuning with AWS GPU Instances and SigOpt."
- Personal blog (`scottclark.io/blog`, 2014, Pyramid/Python self-hosted).

Open-Source Projects (`github.com/sc932`)

- **sc932/resume** — LaTeX
  This CV and resume (524+ GitHub stars, briefly #1 on Hacker News) — *2011 – present*
- **Yelp/MOE — Metric Optimization Engine** — Python, C++, CUDA
  First production Bayesian global-optimization open-source package; basis of SigOpt — *2013 – 2014*
- **sc932/ALE — Assembly Likelihood Estimator**
  Probabilistic evaluation of genome assemblies; published Bioinformatics 2013 (208 cites); maintained through 2
- **sc932/Thesis** — LaTeX
  Cornell PhD dissertation source (mirrors Cornell eCommons download) — *2012*
- **sc932/Velvetrope — Local Sequence Alignment** — Python, C, CUDA
  LANL 2009 practicum output; Chapter 10 of dissertation — *2009 – 2010*

Areas of Expertise

- **Research:** Bayesian optimization, Gaussian processes, optimal learning, multi-armed bandits, hyperparameter tuning, LLM evaluation, agentic-AI systems, AI reliability and testing, experiment design, Monte Carlo methods, bioinformatics and genome assembly, parallel and distributed computing, high-performance computing.
- **Executive:** P&L ownership and strategy at 200-person scale; M&A (sell-side, SigOpt→Intel 2020); fundraising across seed, Series A, and strategic rounds (∼$47M lifetime); board governance (OMSI Treasurer, OSU College of Science).
- **Technical:** Python; LLM and agentic-AI systems design, testing, and evaluation; production-ML observability and anomaly detection; scientific and distributed computing at DOE supercomputer scale (NERSC Cray XT4 PI during PhD); data pipelines; MapReduce-scale distributed ML.
- **Communication:** Several hundred technical talks; extensive podcast circuit; national press quotes; published across industry blogs, peer-reviewed venues, and popular-science outlets.